

Chapter

Natural Vegetation

1. Read the table and identify the pair that is correctly matched:

	Natural Vegetation Belt	Tree
P	Tropical evergreen	Babool
Q	Tropical deciduous	Teak
R	Littoral	Ebony
S	Mountain forest	Banyan

- (a) P
- (b) Q
- (c) R
- (d) S

2. Which type of forest is found mostly in the coastal areas of India?

MAIN 2023

- (a) Tropical Evergreen Forest
- (b) Tropical Desert Forest
- (c) Littoral Forest
- (d) Tropical Deciduous Forest

3. The productive functions of forests include: SQP 2021

- (a) Habitat for the wildlife
- (b) Control the water flow
- (c) Provide various products such as timber, fuel wood, leaves, etc.
- (d) Producing oxygen

4. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched? SQP 2021

- (a) Babool - Tropical evergreen forest
- (b) Sandalwood - Tropical deciduous forest

- (c) Cinchona - Mountain forest
- (d) Sal - Tidal forest

5. How has the rising population of India resulted in the loss of forest cover?(Any one point) MAIN 2024

6. In which natural vegetation belt is Sundari tree found? MAIN 2023

7. Name one region in India where Tropical Evergreen Forest is found.
MAIN 2023

8. Which are the most widespread forests of India ? MAIN 2021

9. State two ways in which forests help in protecting the environment.
MAIN 2023

10. Mention two ways in which Tropical Desert vegetation has adapted to its environment. MAIN 2023

11. Why is the Tropical Deciduous Forest commercially the most exploited forest belt of India? (Two points) MAIN 2023

12. Mention the temperature and rainfall conditions found suitable for its growth. MAIN 2023

13. People do not cut down trees for: MAIN 2022

- (a) making woollen coats
- (b) growing crops
- (c) making furniture
- (d) making houses

14. What is JFM ? MAIN 2021

15. Give a reason to explain each of the following: MAIN 2024

- (a) Mountains have varied vegetation.
- (b) Stilt like/aerial roots are a typical feature of littoral forest.
- (c) The tropical evergreen forests do not look bare at any time of the year.

Solution

1. Thus (b) is correct option.

2. (c) Littoral Forest

The type of forest found mostly in the coastal areas of India is **Littoral Forest**.

3. (c) Provide various products such as timber, fuel wood, leaves, etc.

The productive function of forests includes **providing various products such as timber, fuel wood, leaves, etc.**

4. (b) Sandalwood – Tropical deciduous forest

The correctly matched pair is **Sandalwood – Tropical deciduous forest**.

5. The rising population in India has increased the demand for land for agriculture and housing, leading to deforestation and a loss of forest cover.

6. The **Sundari tree** is found in the **Mangrove forests** (also called littoral or tidal forests), especially in the **Sundarbans** region of India and Bangladesh.

7. Western Ghats

8. Tropical Deciduous Forests.

9. State two ways in which forests help in protecting the environment. Ans

MAIN 2023 Two ways in which forests help in protecting the environment :

(a) Preventing soil erosion : Forests hold the soil in place with their roots, reducing the risk of soil erosion caused by wind and water. (b) Absorbing carbon dioxide : Trees absorb carbon dioxide during photosynthesis, helping to reduce greenhouse gases and mitigate climate change.

10. Two ways in which Tropical Desert vegetation has adapted to its environment are:

(a) **Water Storage and Conservation:** Plants like cacti have thick, fleshy stems to store water and a **waxy coating** to reduce water loss.

(b) **Deep Root Systems:** Many desert plants have **long and extensive roots** to reach underground water and survive droughts.

11. The Tropical Deciduous Forest is commercially the most exploited forest belt in India because:

1. It contains **high-quality hardwoods** like teak and sal, which are valuable for timber and furniture.
2. The trees **shed their leaves seasonally**, making them easier to access for logging and other commercial activities.

12. **Temperature:** Above 25°C

Rainfall: More than 200 cm annually

These warm and humid conditions support the growth of **Tropical Evergreen Forests**, allowing **dense, year-round vegetation**.

13. (a) making woollen coats

People do not cut down trees for **making woollen coats**.

14. JFM (Joint Forest Management) is a programme aimed at developing and protecting forests with the active participation of local communities.

15. (a) **Mountains have varied vegetation:** Vegetation varies with **altitude, temperature, and rainfall**. As altitude increases, temperature decreases, resulting in different vegetation types—from tropical at the base to alpine at higher elevations.

(b) **Stilt-like/aerial roots in littoral forests:** These roots help trees **survive in waterlogged and saline soils**, providing stability and allowing them to **breathe in oxygen-poor conditions**.

(c) **Tropical evergreen forests do not look bare:** Heavy **year-round rainfall** ensures that trees **retain their leaves continuously**, so the forest remains green and dense throughout the year.